

A blue-tinted background image showing a hand holding a smartwatch. The watch screen displays '101', 'FACTORY RHYTHM', 'TEAM', and '0:00:00'. A yellow star icon is positioned above the hand.

The Player-Coach Playbook

M.V.P.  Accelerator™
POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™



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Welcome to the Player-Coach's Corner

Welcome, Player-Coach.

The document you are holding is more than a workbook; it is your command center for the next 10 weeks. While your Athleader is in the arena conditioning their skills, this is your space for strategy, reflection, and growth. You are not just a spectator in their development; you are the most critical member of their coaching staff.

The M.V.P. Accelerator Player-Coach Track is designed with a dual purpose. It will equip you with the frameworks (like A.R.A.W.) and shared language to coach your Athleader through their journey effectively. But just as importantly, it is a dedicated space for you to condition your leadership muscles. We believe that to lead others effectively, you must first lead yourself well. The best coaches are also dedicated players, constantly sharpening their own skills.

Use this Playbook to translate the concepts from the videos into tangible actions. The drills within are designed to be practical, relevant, and immediately applicable to the real-world challenges you face as a leader, from driving team alignment and retaining top talent to managing your own energy and preventing burnout. This is your journey to becoming a more impactful, aligned, and resilient leader.

Use this space in this playbook to reflect deeply, plan strategically, and commit to action. Right now, establish the time you will commit to make this a priority: Block 45-60 minutes on your calendar each week (in one block or across multiple times) and schedule a meeting with yourself to ensure you don't allow anyone else to take this valuable time away from an investment in yourself. This is your journey. Own it.

You've got this!

CEO, Velvet Suite

Founder, Athleadership® Movement



Lesson 1

Suit Up - Your Leadership M.V.P.



“The foundation of every great team is a clear, committed partnership between the player and the Player-Coach.”



Drill 1.1

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 1

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to your first week, Player-Coach. This week is about laying the foundation for a successful 10-week season by establishing:

Alignment

Before you begin, this drill helps you anchor your focus in the growth you identified in your pre-program assessment.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Understand your role as a Player-Coach in the Athleadership model.
- » Define your own “Player-Coach Intention” with a focus on your wellbeing and leadership growth.
- » Identify a key “Player-Coach Multiplier” opportunity with your Athleader.
- » Facilitate a structured “Commient Meeting” to create a foundation of trust and clarity.



Action

Ground Your Intention.

Review the two questions you reflected on at the start of this lesson. Keep them front and center as you complete these drills to ensure your work is targeted and meaningful.

- » *What is one leadership behavior you want to strengthen for yourself?*
- » *What is one leadership behavior you want to improve in how you support your team’s performance?*

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 1.2

LEAD SELF — Define Your Player-Coach Intention

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.2)



Instructions:

Great coaching starts with self-awareness. Before you can guide your Athleader, you need to know what you want out of this experience for your own growth. This is your first step in leading yourself (**Alignment** and **Well-being**), so you can more effectively lead others.

Reflection & Action

1 Identify Your Pressure Point:

Identify Your Pressure Point: What is one specific pressure point (e.g., tight deadlines, team conflict, managing up) you are currently facing in your role? *(This helps you focus on a real-world challenge where you can apply what you are learning immediately.)*



My Response

2 Define Your Well-being Practice

What is one well-being practice (e.g., taking a 15-minute walk at lunch, ending the workday at a set time, delegating one task) you can implement this week to manage that pressure and perform sustainably? *(This is your first A.R.A.W. check-in, connecting well-being directly to performance.)*

 My Response

3 State Your Intention

Combine your reflections into a single, powerful intention statement. *(This intention will be your anchor for the next 10 weeks, and you will share it with your Athleader.)*

 My intention for this M.V.P. Accelerator season is to



Great leaders
don't wait for
change - they
create it.

Drill 1.3

LEAD OTHERS — Identify the Multiplier Effect

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.3)



Instructions:
Your leadership is a catalyst. This drill helps you strategically focus your coaching on the area where your Athleader’s growth will have the biggest ripple effect on the team and business, maximizing the “Player-Coach Multiplier Effect.”

Reflection & Action

1 Identify a Growth Area

What is one area of growth for your Athleader (e.g., technical skill, presentation skills, cross-functional collaboration) that, if improved, would have the largest positive impact on the rest of the team?



My Response

2

Connect to a Business Goal

How does this growth area connect to one of your team’s key business goals for this quarter?
(This creates clear alignment between individual development and business outcomes.)



My Response

3

Align with Stakeholders

How could you align stakeholders outside of your immediate team to support this goal? Have you translated direction from your senior leaders into clear, actionable steps for your team related to this? *(This drill links to the survey theme of organizational alignment and ensuring your team understands the “why” behind their work.)*



My Response

Drill 1.4

LEAD OTHERS — The First Conversation Playbook

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.4)



Instructions:

This meeting is the single most important play call of this lesson. It moves your relationship from one of unspoken assumptions to one of explicit, aligned partnership. Use this detailed playbook to structure the conversation.



Action

Agenda & Talking Points

1 Opening: The Dual Journey (5 mins)

Player-Coach: “Thanks for meeting. I’m excited to go on this journey with you as a partnership. While you’re going through the

Athleader track, I’m going through this Player-Coach track to become a better Player-Coach for you and the team.”

2 Sharing Intentions (10 mins)

Ask Your Athleader: “In your first lesson, you set a ‘Championship Season Intention.’ I’d love to hear what that is. What is the most important transformation you’re aiming for?”

now?” or “What would achieving that unlock for you?”

Listen Intently. Ask clarifying questions like, “What makes that so important to you right

Share Your Intention: “Thank you for sharing. My intention as your Player-Coach is [Share your intention from Drill 1.2]. I’m sharing this because I want us to hold each other accountable and be partners in this growth.”

“I am a manager who manages several participants.”

Great. This journey supports your growth and your team’s. If you manage multiple participants, hold one 30-minute Commitment Meeting with each person at the start. After that, build the 15-minute check-ins into your existing meeting rhythm. No need to create additional meetings.

3 Defining a “Win” & Setting a Cadence (5 mins)

Co-Create a Vision: “Looking ahead 10 weeks, what does a huge ‘win’ look like for both of us as a result of this program?”

this program. This will be our dedicated time to connect on your progress. Let’s get it on the calendar now.”

Set the Rhythm: “Let’s set up a recurring [weekly 15-minute] check-in specifically for

4 Agreeing on Support & Psychological Safety (10 mins)

Ask for Needs: “What is the most important thing you need from me to feel supported and safe to take risks on this journey?” (This question directly addresses the core competency of creating psychological safety, a key theme in your survey.)

State Your Needs: “To be the best Player-Coach I can be for you, what I need is [e.g., for you to be proactive in sharing your insights, for you to be open when you face a challenge]. This will help us build a strong foundation of trust.”



My Response

Locker Room Reflection

(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 1.4)

Challenge: During your commient meeting, your Athleader seems hesitant and gives very general answers about their goals. How do you apply the principle of **psychological safety** to encourage openness without applying pressure? What specific question could you ask to build trust?



Lesson 2

The Leader's Scouting Report



“You can’t coach
what you can’t
see. The best
coaches see the
potential inside a
player before the
player sees it in
themselves.”



Drill 2.1

Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 2*

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 2.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to Lesson 2. This week is about data, not spreadsheets, but the human data that drives performance. Your Athleader is creating their “Inner Blueprint” by defining their M.V.P.+V. (Mission, Vision, Purpose + Values). Your role is to help them analyze this data with curiosity, while also conducting an honest scouting report on yourself.

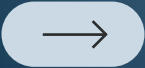
► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Define your own non-negotiable leadership M.V.P.+V. to create a shared language with your Athleader.
- » Practice coaching techniques that foster psychological safety.
- » Prepare to use the “Forward-Looking Feedback” framework to make feedback developmental, not judgmental.

Did You Know?

According to a Gallup poll, being ignored by a manager can be more detrimental to an employee’s engagement than receiving negative feedback. This lesson gives you the tools to engage meaningfully.

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 2.2

LEAD SELF — Your Leadership M.V.P.+V. Scouting Report

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 2.2)



Instructions:
Your Athleader is defining their Inner Blueprint. To be an effective Player-Coach, you need your own playbook. This drill is a streamlined, high-impact version of your Athleader's M.V.P. work, designed to give you clarity on your own leadership identity (**Alignment**) and directly prepares you for the survey questions on this topic.

Part 1

Your Core Values:

Your values are your non-negotiable principles that guide your decisions under pressure. Brainstorm 10-15 values that are important to you, then force-rank them to identify your essential Core 3.



My Core Values:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Part 2

Architecting Your M.V.P.

My Purpose (My “Why”):

What is the fundamental reason your leadership matters? What is the lasting impact you want to have on the people you lead?



My Response

My Vision (My “Where”):

What is the vivid picture of the future you are creating for your team and your own career over the next 1-3 years? What does winning look like?

 My Response

My Mission (My “How”):

What do you do every day to make your vision a reality? How do you operationalize your purpose?

Template → I will [ACTION] for [AUDIENCE] by [FOCUS AREA] to [RESULT].

 My Response

Part 3

Alignment Reflection

How can you use this M.V.P. statement in your next team meeting to better align your team’s priorities with a sense of purpose?

 My Response



Drill 2.3

LEAD OTHERS — Coaching for Psychological Safety

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 2.3)



Instructions:

This week, your task is to create a safe space for your Athleader to share their insights and challenges beyond status updates. This builds the trust necessary for true development.



Action

In your next check-in with your Athleader, your goal is to ask one of the following open-ended, non-judgmental questions and then **listen to the answer without immediately trying to solve it**. Your role here is to be curious, not to fix.

- » *“What’s been the most surprising insight for you in this self-discovery process so far?”*
- » *“As you’ve been reflecting on your values, what’s felt most energizing or even challenging?”*
- » *“What part of this Inner Blueprint work feels most relevant to the challenges you’re facing right now?”*



If your team can’t
tell you the truth,
they’ll protect you
from problems
instead of helping
you solve them.

Drill 2.4

LEAD OTHERS — The Forward-Looking Feedback Framework

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 2.4)

Instructions:
This 3-step framework is designed to make your next feedback conversation more impactful and less intimidating for both you and your Athleader. It shifts the focus from past mistakes to future growth.

Action
Think of one piece of feedback (either positive or constructive) you need to give your Athleader. Plan your specific language for each step using the playbook below.

1 Acknowledge (Validate the Effort):
How will you start by validating their effort, intent, or the situation? This lowers defensiveness.

Example Language

“I want to acknowledge the hard work you put into...” or “I recognize the pressure you were under when...”

Your Planned Opening

2 Connect (Bridge to the Future):
What future-focused question will you ask to connect the past event to a future opportunity?

Example Language

“Based on that experience, what’s one lesson we can apply to the upcoming project?” or “Thinking ahead, how might we approach a similar situation differently to get an even better outcome?”

Your Connecting Question

3 Co-Create (Empower Ownership):
How will you empower them to own the next step? This turns feedback into an action plan.

Example Language

“What’s one small action you think you could take this week based on this?” or “What support do you need from me to make that happen?”

Your Co-Created Next Step

Locker Room Reflection

(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 2.4)

Challenge: You notice your Athleader is only sharing positive updates and successes. How can you gently create an opening for them to discuss challenges, reinforcing that this is a safe space for growth, not just performance reporting? What specific question might you ask?

 My Response

 My Response

 My notes



Lesson 3

The 90-Day Way Game Plan



“An amateur
has a goal. A
professional has
a system.”

- James Clear.



Drill 3.1

Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 3*

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 3.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to Lesson 3. This is where the M.V.P. Blueprint moves from a strategic document to a tactical, executable plan. Your Athleader is building their first 90-Day Plan to translate their purpose into focused action. Your role is to be their crucial Alignment check, ensuring their plan is both ambitious and achievable. You will also model the focus you expect by building your own plan.

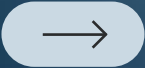
► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Draft your own tactical 90-Day Leadership Plan to model focus and clarity.
- » Learn how to introduce the 90-Day Way framework as a team alignment tool.
- » Prepare to Player-Coach your team through the inevitable roadblocks and skepticism that come with any new plan.

Did You Know?

Research suggests that 92% of people who set goals fail to achieve them. The difference isn't the goal itself, but having a system to execute consistently. The 90-Day Way is that system.

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 3.2

LEAD SELF — Your 90-Day Game Plan

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 3.2)



Instructions:

You cannot lead a team with a clear game plan if you haven't defined one for yourself. This drill moves you from theory to action, forcing you to gain clarity on your leadership priorities for the coming quarter. Use this template to architect your focus.



Action

Complete the template below. Start by anchoring your goal in your M.V.P. statement from Lesson 2.

My 90-Day Leadership Game Plan

1

M.V.P. Anchor:

(Review your M.V.P. from Drill 2.2. How does this goal serve your Purpose, Vision, or Mission?)

2

My #1 Leadership Goal for the Next 90 Days:

(What is the single most important leadership behavior or outcome you want to achieve? Be specific.)



My Response



My Response

3 A.R.A.W. Pillar
Under Pressure:

(Which Core 4 pillar will this goal test the most? This helps you anticipate where you'll need to focus your energy.)

● Agility

Requires adapting to new information or changing priorities.

● Resilience

Requires bouncing back from a setback or managing stress.

● Alignment

Requires getting buy-in from others or connecting to a larger strategy.

● Well-being

Requires getting buy-in from others or connecting to a larger strategy.

4 The #1 Anticipated Roadblock:

(What is the biggest obstacle—internal or external—that could derail this goal?)

✎ My Response

5 My Proactive Reframe Plan:

(How will you proactively address this roadblock? What powerful question can you ask yourself to reframe it as an opportunity?)

✎ My Response



Drill 3.3

LEAD OTHERS —
Introducing the 90-Day Way

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 3.3)



Instructions:

Your play is to introduce the 90-Day Way framework to your team, not as another initiative, but as a tool to build shared focus and reduce noise. This drill helps you prepare your talking points for maximum impact.



Action

Plan your talking points for your next team meeting using the playbook below.

Team Meeting Prep Worksheet

1

The “Why” (Your Benefit Statement)

How will you explain the benefit of this framework to the team? Frame it as a solution to a shared pain point.



Your “Why” Statement



Example

“To help us cut through the noise of competing priorities and protect our focus, we’re going to try a simple framework called the 90-Day Way. This is a tool to help us clarify what truly matters this quarter so we can make a real impact and feel less stretched.”



2 The Facilitation Question

What is the one powerful, open-ended question you will ask to start the conversation about a shared 90-day goal?

Example

“Looking at our key priorities, what is the one thing that, if we achieve it this quarter, will make the biggest difference for our customers and the business?”

Your Facilitation Question




Align your focus,
act with intention,
and watch results
compound — that’s
The 90-Day Way in
action.

LEAD OTHERS — Coaching Through Skepticism & Roadblocks

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 3.4)



Instructions:
Your role as a Player-Coach is to build your team’s **Resilience** by helping them anticipate and reframe obstacles. This drill prepares you for two common challenges: skepticism and roadblocks.

Action Part 1

Coaching Through Skepticism



Scenario
You introduce the 90-Day Way, and a team member expresses skepticism, seeing it as “just another corporate initiative that will fade.” How do you address their concern and build buy-in? (Hint: Connect it to a pain point they are feeling, like meeting overload or unclear priorities.)



Your Response Plan

Action Part 2

The Roadblock Reframe

Anticipate a potential roadblock for your team’s new 90-day goal and prepare a powerful coaching question to spark creative problem-solving instead of defeat.



My Response

Anticipated Roadblock

(e.g., A budget cut, a shifting deadline, a key dependency is delayed).

Your Powerful Question

(This question should shift the team from “we can’t” to “how could we?”)



My Response



Example

“This is a tough constraint. What new possibilities or creative solutions does this force us to consider?”

Locker Room Reflection

*(This reflection corresponds to
the Real-World Challenge from
Video Topic 3.4)*

Challenge: A new, urgent corporate
priority drops in the middle of your
team’s 90-day plan. How do you use
the 90-Day Way framework to help
your team adapt with **Agility**, reassess
priorities without losing momentum,
and manage their *Wellbeing* to
prevent burnout?

 My Response

 My notes



Lesson 4

Activate Your M.V.P. Under Pressure



“Pressure is
a privilege - it
only comes
to those who
have earned it.”

- *Billie Jean King*



Drill 4.1

Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 4*

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to Lesson 4. A plan is just a theory until it meets reality. This week is about activating your M.V.P. when it matters most—when the pressure is on and the stakes are high. This is where leadership is truly revealed and conditioned, and where your **Resilience** and **Agility** are tested.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Develop your personal “Resilience Playbook” consciously to manage your reactions under stress.
- » Learn to diagnose the root cause of resistance to change within your team.
- » Practice coaching for agility to help your Athleader and team pivot effectively.

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 4.2

LEAD SELF — Your Resilience Playbook

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.2)



Instructions:

Your team's resilience is a direct reflection of your own. An emotionally regulated leader promotes psychological safety and clear thinking. This drill helps you move from being reactive to being responsive by defining your go-to plays for staying calm and focused under pressure.



Action

Identify 2-3 common stress triggers and design a specific “Resilience Play” for each.



My Resilience Playbook

Common Stress Trigger

(What is a recurring situation at work that causes you to feel stressed, overwhelmed, or reactive?)

My “Resilience Play”

(What is one simple, immediate action you can take to create a pause between the trigger and your reaction?)

A.R.A.W. Pillar Strengthened

(Wellbeing, Resilience, etc.)

Example

Receiving an unexpected, critical email from a senior leader.

Example

Stand up, walk to get water. Do not reply for at least 10 minutes.

Example

Well-being / Resilience

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

My Response:

Drill 4.3

LEAD OTHERS — Diagnosing Resistance to Change

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.3)



Instructions:

Resistance to change is rarely about the change itself; it's about a perceived loss. Your play as a Player-Coach is to listen beyond the surface-level complaints to diagnose what your team fears they will lose. Understanding this is the key to unlocking buy-in.



Action

Think of a recent change you led (or are currently leading). Analyze the resistance to identify the primary root fear.

Change Analysis Worksheet

1

The Change Initiative

(Briefly describe the change.)



My Response



2 The Root Fear

(Based on your team's questions and behaviors, what was the primary fear driving resistance? Check the most dominant one and provide your evidence below.)

● Loss of Certainty

(Fear of the unknown, ambiguity, lack of a clear plan)

● Loss of Competence:

(Fear of not being able to adapt, learn new skills, or succeed in the new environment)

● Loss of Connection

(Fear of a change to team dynamics, relationships, or informal networks)

Evidence / Observations

(What did you see or hear that points to this specific fear?)

My Response

Coaching Corner: Understanding this fundamentally changes how you will lead the next change. How can you proactively address this specific fear the next time you introduce a new initiative?

Drill 4.4

LEAD OTHERS — The Agility Coaching Question

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 4.4)



Instructions:

A Player-Coach who always provides the answer creates dependency. A Player-Coach who asks powerful questions builds **Agility**. Your role is to build your Athleader's capacity to solve problems by shifting from "problem-solver-in-chief" to "question-asker."



Action

Add the following powerful question to your coaching toolkit. The next time your Athleader brings you a problem, resist the urge to solve it and make this your first response.

Your Go-To Agility Question

"That's a tough challenge. What's your initial read on a path forward?"



Practice Plan

Identify a specific, upcoming situation or meeting where you can practice using this question this week.



Situation / Person

Reflection

How does asking this question first, instead of providing a solution, change the dynamic of the conversation?

 My Response

 My notes

Locker Room Reflection

(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 4.4)

Challenge & Self-Scouting: When you are under pressure, does your team see you as a source of calm or a source of stress? What is one specific behavior you can change this week (leveraging your Resilience Playbook from Drill 4.2) to better model resilience and composure for your team?

 My Response



Lesson 5

Play the Season — Sustainable Performance



“Rest isn’t a bug;
it’s a feature of
high performance.
It’s the strategic
pause that fuels
the next sprint.”



Drill 5.1

Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 5*

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to Lesson 5. We are deep into the season, where cumulative fatigue can derail even the best plans. This lesson is about the science of sustainable high performance. The best Athleaders and coaches know that victory depends on managing **Well-being** and energy, not just time. Your role is to model these sustainable practices to ensure you and your team can finish the season strong and avoid burnout.

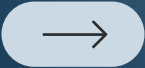
► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Conduct a personal “Energy Audit” to identify and manage your key energy drains and sources.
- » Learn to consciously model sustainable work practices to influence your team’s culture.
- » Develop a proactive plan for facilitating team recovery after intense periods of effort.

The Science of Performance

In a study of high-performing leaders, 94% reported working more than 50 hours a week, and over half reported feeling burned out. This lesson provides the tactical plays to counter this trend.

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 5.2

LEAD SELF — The Personal Energy Audit

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.2)



Instructions:
The most effective leaders are masters of energy management. Time is finite, but energy is renewable if managed correctly. This drill helps you gather data on your personal energy drains and fuel sources so you can optimize your performance.



Action
For one full workday this week, use the log below to track your energy. At several points during the day, note the activity you were just doing and how it made you feel.

My Daily Energy Audit Log

Time of Day	Activity / Meeting / Task	Energy Level After Activity (Mark one)		
e.g., 10:00 AM	e.g., Team Budget Review Meeting	☐ Drained	☐ Neutral	☒ Energized
		☐ Drained	☐ Neutral	☐ Energized
		☐ Drained	☐ Neutral	☐ Energized
		☐ Drained	☐ Neutral	☐ Energized
		☐ Drained	☐ Neutral	☐ Energized

Analysis & Action Plan

1 My Biggest Energy Drainer Was

(What single activity had the most negative impact on your energy?)

 My Response

2 My Biggest Energy Giver Was

(What single activity had the most positive impact on your energy?)

 My Response

3 One Change I Will Make

(Based on this audit, what is one specific change you can make to your schedule or workflow next week to minimize a drain or maximize a giver?)

 My Response



Drill 5.3

LEAD OTHERS — Modeling Sustainable Practices

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.3)



Instructions:

Your habits create your team’s norms. The phrase “do as I say, not as I do” is the quickest way to lose credibility as a leader. Your play is to consciously model one behavior that sends a powerful signal to your team that **Well-being** is a non-negotiable part of high performance.



Action

Choose **one** of the following plays to run consistently this week. Check the box to commit to it.

☐ The Full Break

Take a full lunch break, completely away from your desk and email, and encourage your team to do the same.

☐ The “Schedule Send” Play

Use the “schedule send” feature for all emails written after 6 PM, ensuring they arrive during business hours the next day.

☐ The Gift of Time:

Proactively end a meeting you are leading 5-10 minutes early, explicitly giving everyone back time to transition.

☐ The Disconnect Praise

Explicitly praise a team member for taking their vacation time and fully disconnecting, reinforcing that rest is valued.



My Response



Reflection

Why is modeling one of these behaviors more powerful than simply telling your team to “take care of their well-being”?

Drill 5.4

LEAD OTHERS — The Team Recovery Protocol

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.4)



Instructions:

In sports, recovery isn't optional; it's a strategic part of the training cycle. The same is true for elite teams in business. Your play is to proactively plan for your team's recovery before they hit the wall after their next big push.



Action

Complete the Team Recovery Protocol Planner below, and then schedule the recovery event on the team calendar now. This makes it real.

Team Recovery Protocol Planner

1 Identify the Next Big Push

(What is the next major deadline, project launch, or intense period for your team?)



Project / Deadline



Target Date



2 Schedule a Recovery Protocol

(What is one small but meaningful thing you can do as a team within a few days of that date to acknowledge the effort and facilitate recovery?)

 Example

A celebratory team lunch, a “no-meetings” afternoon, a retrospective focused only on lessons learned and celebrating wins, a half-day for professional development.

 My Team’s Recovery Protocol




Recovery isn’t
a pause from
performance —
it’s the rhythm that
makes sustained
performance possible.

Locker Room Reflection

(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 5.4)

Challenge: What is one “unwritten rule” or implicit expectation on your team that might be contributing to a culture of burnout (e.g., everyone stays online late, instant Teams/Slack responses are expected, lunch is eaten at the desk)? What is one specific step you can take as the leader to begin to change it?

 My Response

 My notes



Lesson 6

The Victory Lap & The Next Season



“The final whistle of one season is the starting pistol for the next. Celebrate the win, but never forget what it takes to win again.”



Drill 6.1

Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 6*

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 6.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to your final lesson, Player-Coach. This isn't just an ending; it's a commencement. It's about celebrating the progress you and your Athleader have made, solidifying the learning to ensure it sticks, and intentionally planning for what comes next. A true victory isn't just finishing the program; it's using the momentum to fuel the next season of growth.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Reflect on and create a system to cement your own new leadership habits.
- » Master the “Championship Conversation” to celebrate your Athleader’s success and provide career-accelerating visibility.
- » Create a clear coaching plan for your Athleader’s next 90-day season of growth.

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 6.2

LEAD SELF — Cementing Your Leadership Habits

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 6.2)



Instructions:

The goal of this program was to help you build new leadership habits, not just learn new ideas. This drill is about making them permanent by building a system around your most impactful new practice.



Action

Complete the Habit Integration Plan below.

My Leadership Habit Integration Plan

1

Identify Your Most Impactful New Habit:

(Look back through this playbook. What is the one new practice or framework (e.g., The Energy Audit, The A.R.A.W. Coaching Prep, The Forward-Looking Feedback model) that has been most valuable for you as a leader?)



My Response

2 Schedule the Habit
(Build Your System)

(How will you build a system to ensure this practice continues? Be specific about the trigger and the schedule.)

 Example

If it were the Energy Audit, your system might be: "Every Friday at 2:00 PM (my trigger), I will block 15 minutes on my calendar (my system) to review the week's energy and plan for the next."

 My System



What you do
daily, determines
who you become
permanently.

Drill 6.3

LEAD OTHERS — The Championship Conversation Playbook

(This drill corresponds to Video Topics 6.3 & 6.4)



Instructions:

This is your final, most important play call. Your task is to facilitate the “Championship Huddle,” a conversation designed to make your Athleader’s success visible and sustainable. This playbook breaks it down into three critical parts.



Action

Plan your Championship Conversation using this playbook.

The Championship Huddle: A 3-Part Playbook

Part 1

CELEBRATE Publicly

(Recognition fuels motivation. How will you publicly acknowledge your Athleader’s growth and commient? Check all that apply and add your ideas.)

- ☐ Acknowledge their specific growth and contribution in our next team meeting.
- ☐ Send a recognition email highlighting their key accomplishment to our team and key stakeholders.
- ☐ Nominate them for a formal company award or recognition program.



My Own Idea

Part 2

PROVIDE Visibility

(Advocacy accelerates careers. This is a key theme from your survey. How will you use your influence to give them exposure to senior leadership?)

Identify a Key Senior Leader

(Who is one leader whose awareness of your Athleader’s work would be beneficial for their career?)



My Response

Plan the Connection

(Choose your play and plan the specifics.)



The Introduction

Schedule a brief, informal 15-minute virtual coffee for the three of us.



The Strategic Update

Send a concise note or email to that leader highlighting your Athleader’s key accomplishment and how it ties to a broader business goal.

The Message

What is the one key accomplishment or new skill you want to highlight?



My Response

PLAN the Next Season

(Momentum is built on a clear vision for what's next. Prepare your key coaching question for your final program check-in.)

Your Go-To Coaching Question

“This was a great season of growth. Based on everything you've learned and accomplished, what is your primary focus or #1 goal for your next 90-day season?”

Capture Their Goal

(Listen and capture their response here. This becomes the foundation for your coaching conversations next quarter.)

Locker Room Reflection

(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 6.4)

Challenge: Of the three plays in the Championship Conversation (**Celebrate**, **Provide Visibility**, and **Plan the Next Season**), which one do you believe will have the most significant long-term impact on your Athleader’s career momentum and engagement at the company, and why?

Player’s Next 90-Day Focus

My Response

My notes